

SUSTAINABLE PROCUREMENT POLICY

Rationale

The University of Mindanao (UM) is committed to fostering environmental sustainability and social responsibility in all its operations. Recognizing the significant impact of its procurement activities, UM is dedicated to implementing a sustainable procurement policy that prioritizes environmental considerations, promotes resource efficiency, and ensures the responsible management of hazardous substances throughout the lifecycle of goods and services.

This policy seeks to integrate sustainability into every stage of the procurement process, prioritizing eco-friendly, energy-efficient, and responsibly sourced goods and services, while promoting compliance with environmental laws and best practices. By doing so, it aims to minimize its ecological footprint, encourage sustainable practices among suppliers, and foster a culture of informed, ethical, and responsible consumption across the University.

Scope

This policy applies to all procurement activities undertaken by all units, departments, colleges, and offices of the University of Mindanao, including the acquisition of goods, services, works, and consultancy services, regardless of funding source or procurement method.

Guiding Principles

The University of Mindanao will adhere to the following guiding principles in its procurement activities:

Environmental Impact Minimization. Prioritize goods and services with lower environmental impact throughout their lifecycle, considering factors such as resource consumption, emissions, waste generation, and biodiversity.

Recyclability and Reusability. Favor products that are made from recycled content, are easily recyclable at the end of their life, and are designed for reuse or remanufacturing.

Energy Conservation and Efficiency. Select energy-efficient products and services to reduce energy consumption and greenhouse gas emissions. This includes considering the energy performance of equipment, appliances, and buildings.

Proper Handling of Hazardous Substances. Ensure that any hazardous substances procured are handled, stored, used, and disposed of in a manner that minimizes risks to human health and the environment, in accordance with relevant regulations and best practices. Explore safer alternatives whenever feasible.

Life Cycle Costing. Consider the total cost of ownership, including acquisition, operation, maintenance, and disposal costs, when evaluating procurement options. Environmentally preferable products may have higher upfront costs but lower long-term environmental and financial impacts.

Supplier Engagement. Encourage and prioritize suppliers who demonstrate commitment to sustainable practices, including environmental management systems, ethical labor standards, and transparent supply chains.

Local and Sustainable Sourcing. Where feasible and economically viable, prioritize the procurement of goods and services from local sources and those that promote sustainable economic development within the region.

Precautionary Principle: In the absence of scientific certainty, the University will take a precautionary approach to prevent potential environmental harm.

Transparency and Accountability. Maintain transparency in procurement processes and ensure accountability for implementing this policy.

Compliance

All University personnel involved in procurement activities are required to adhere to the principles and procedures outlined in this policy. Compliance with relevant environmental laws, regulations, and institutional guidelines is mandatory. Suppliers and contractors are likewise expected to meet the University's sustainability standards as part of their engagement. Non-compliance by internal stakeholders may result in administrative sanctions, while external partners may face contract review, suspension, or termination. The University reserves the right to audit procurement practices and take corrective actions to ensure alignment with its sustainability objectives.

Implementation and Review

The University of Mindanao shall implement this Sustainable Procurement Policy through a comprehensive approach that integrates sustainability criteria into every stage of the procurement cycle -from needs assessment and vendor selection to contract management and performance evaluation. The University will develop specific sustainable procurement guidelines and checklists and conduct regular training and awareness programs to equip personnel with the necessary knowledge and skills to effectively apply sustainable procurement principles.

The policy will be reviewed regularly to incorporate advancements in technology, regulatory updates, and evolving best practices. Reviews will be led by the Procurement Office and submitted to Quality Management Office for review and evaluation and will be endorsed to the Executive Committee for approval. All updates will be formally communicated to stakeholders and implemented upon official issuance through the University website, internal memos, and training programs.



Office of the President
Ground Floor, Research Tower Building
#1 Bolton St. Barangay 3-A, Poblacion, Davao City
Telefax No. (082) 221-7035
Phone No. (082) 227-5456 Local 105/110

Signed:

(Sgd) GUILLERMO P. TORRES, JR.
University President